Mike Spaeth – Global AI Strategy Leader Judge and Keynote

Mike Spaeth is a globally recognized leader in AI and public policy, with over two decades of experience scaling transformative technologies across industries. He currently serves as Global Vice President at the United States Artificial Intelligence Institute (USAII®), where he leads global strategy, high-performing team development, and strategic partnerships to drive adoption of industry-leading certifications, training, and consulting.

At USAII®, Mike is at the forefront of AI workforce transformation—guiding the institute's mission to equip professionals, students, and organizations with future-ready skills

through customizable, world-class programs. With AI projected to reach $15 trillion by 2030, he plays a critical role in expanding AI literacy and capability across sectors and geographies.

Prior to USAII, Mike served as Global Director of Generative AI at EarthDaily, in this role he worked closely with Microsoft, Google, IBM and other companies in providing them with Satellite data to improve their GenAI Foundation models.

He has also held Executive roles at IBM, Moody's and various AI start-ups. At IBM, Watson won Jeopardy, and he worked closely on the WatsonX Go to Market initiatives. Earlier in his career, he shaped public policy as a Legislative Associate for U.S. Senator Frank Lautenberg and campaign leader for Clinton/Gore, while running for State Assembly in NJ.

Mike's expertise bridges the worlds of corporate innovation, AI education and policy advocacy. He holds both a Bachelor of Arts and a Master of Public Administration from Seton Hall University.

Garett Chang-Judge

Garett Chang is President and Chief Executive Officer of Highstep Technologies, a technology consulting and digital modernization firm he has led since 2001. Over the past 25 years, Garett has guided Highstep's growth into a trusted partner for utilities, public sector agencies, and enterprise organizations seeking to modernize legacy systems, streamline operations, and implement data-driven solutions.

Nicole Gizzi-judge

Nicole Gizzi is a Cybersecurity Consultant at Ernst & Young (EY), where she helps organizations navigate cybersecurity risk, strengthen data protection, and develop strategies that align security with business objectives. She graduated from the Seton Hall University Stillman School of Business, where she built a multidisciplinary foundation across information technology, finance, marketing, and cybersecurity. Nicole is also the Alumni Chair for the Seton Hall Cybersecurity Club, where she mentors students and coaches teams competing in national cybersecurity strategy competitions. She is passionate about helping students grow their skills and gain confidence tackling real-world cybersecurity challenges. Nicole is looking forward to seeing the creative approaches to complex problems and values solutions that combine innovation with practical impact in the Hackathon.

Anurima Sandhu- Judge

Anurima Sandhu brings nearly a decade of product management experience building products across the B2B, B2C, and Life Sciences sectors. With a foundational background in Data Engineering and a career that includes key roles at Microsoft, Amazon, and AbbVie, she excels at bridging technical architecture with user-centric product strategy. Beyond building great software and products, she is passionate about investing and personal finance. Outside work, she loves hiking and playing pickleball.